



WINNING MALE
USERS ON
MEESHO

**BUSINESS
TRACK**

Ecommerce Landscape in India

E-commerce in India has been shaped by factors such as rising internet usage, the spread of smartphones, and the adoption of digital payments. The sector spans areas like retail, electronics, and services, with multiple players operating at scale, including Flipkart, Amazon, and Meesho. Category consumption patterns, however, differ meaningfully by demographic — electronics, mobiles, and gadgets have historically driven a large share of male purchase intent online, while categories like fashion, beauty, and home decor have driven a large share of female purchase intent. Platforms that have built deep strength in one set of categories often find themselves under-indexed with the demographic that skews toward the other.

What e-commerce looks like for Male users on Meesho

Meesho's growth has been powered by a broad, affordable catalog spanning fashion, beauty, jewellery, and home & kitchen categories where its zero-commission seller model and value-first positioning have found strong resonance, particularly among female shoppers. This has made Meesho a household name for a large and loyal female user base across India.

However, this same catalog strength has left a gap on the other side: male penetration on the platform remains low, and male user lifetime value (LTV) is significantly lower than that of the female cohort. Male users who do install the app show weak activation and poor repeat behavior. Anecdotally and through limited existing insight, we understand that:

- Male users are highly "**sticky**" to competition, largely driven by the electronics and mobile-accessories use case, where competition has built strong brand assurance, financing options, and after-sales credibility.
- There is a perception that Meesho is a platform "**for women**" — shaped by catalog composition, app merchandising, and marketing/influencer choices that skew toward a female audience.
- Quality and returns concerns, while present across the platform, are felt more acutely by male users.

As Meesho looks to grow its user base beyond its founding strength, closing the male penetration and LTV gap represents a large, largely untapped opportunity — but one that comes with a distinct set of structural barriers rather than a simple marketing fix.

Objective

"Design a comprehensive strategy to increase Meesho's penetration and lifetime value among male users — spanning new user acquisition, category expansion, and retention — while protecting the trust and brand equity Meesho has built with its existing, predominantly female customer base."

Meesho's journey has seen wide participation from customers and sellers in towns and smaller cities, supported by a broad catalog and a zero-commission approach for sellers. The business ecosystem is shaped by a cycle of customer demand, seller participation, efficient fulfillment, and a focus on solving for user needs.

If a platform like Meesho were to make male user growth a key focus area, how could it think about meaningfully closing the gender penetration and LTV gap in the next 3-5 years?

How can Meesho acquire and retain male customers — who have different category needs, different trust thresholds, and different competitive alternatives — while keeping its mission and values intact? Conduct a deep dive into this by assessing the current male customer landscape on Meesho, emerging demand trends among male shoppers online, the competitive landscape, and customising Meesho's current business strategy to serve this segment.

Challenges that Meesho has historically faced on this problem

Meesho's catalog and brand identity have developed strong resonance with female shoppers, but this has come at the cost of limited depth in categories — electronics, gadgets, sports and auto accessories — that typically drive male purchase intent. Male users often perceive Meesho as a platform built primarily for women, an impression reinforced by app merchandising, homepage curation, and marketing/influencer choices. Existing loyalty to competition, anchored brand assurance, and financing options make switching or even trial harder to justify. Quality and returns concerns — while a platform-wide issue — carry higher stakes for male users. As a result, even where male users are acquired, activation and repeat usage remain weak, keeping male LTV substantially below the platform average.

Expectations

Required output: Prepare a presentation summarising your findings / recommendations. Your presentation should be clear, concise and visually engaging, demonstrating your strategic thinking & problem solving skills.

3-Slider submission:

- What does a first-time male user expect from an e-commerce marketplace? Which male sub-segment or category should Meesho focus on first?
- What key changes are required in Meesho's business model (categories, quality assurance, fulfillment, returns policy, brand/marketing) to credibly serve male users?
- Media Plan (story + distribution), Sizing & GTM strategy.

Detailed-deck submission (6-10 slides): Include the deliverables of Round 1 in the final 6-10 slides

- Executive Summary
- Identify the avenues that can contribute to male user acquisition and LTV growth for Meesho
- Market opportunity and sizing (Total addressable market size, gap analysis, trigger analysis, competitor analysis)
- Resource enhancement/business penetration ideas to achieve the goal
- Go-to-Market strategy for Meesho, incl. media plan that communicates the solves effectively
- Recommendations to address the goal in short-term and long-term
- Define key success metrics & KPIs to measure effectiveness of solutions
- Key risks in implementation (including risk of diluting the existing female-first brand equity)
- Top-line and bottom-line plan

Evaluation Criteria

3-Slider Submission Round:

1. Extent of Research - Methods, Sources, Coverage
2. Quality of Insights
3. User-First Approach
4. Problem-First Mindset

Detailed deck submission:

1. Quality of Research - Methods, Sources, Coverage
2. Depth of Analysis
3. Innovativeness of Recommendations
4. 10x and Long-term Thinking
5. Feasibility of Implementation
6. Presentation Skills

Good luck! We look forward to seeing how you tackle this challenge and come up with innovative ideas for Meesho's growth and success.